

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

DJIA 44922.27 ▲ 10.45 0.02%

NASDAQ 21314.95 ▼ 1.46%

STOXX 600 557.81 ▲ 0.7%

10-YR. TREAS. ▲ 9/32, yield 4.301%

OIL \$62.35 ▼ \$1.07

GOLD \$3,313.40 ▼ \$18.30

EURO \$1.1649

YEN 147.66

What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **Union leaders for Air Canada's** flight attendants said members would return to work after a deal was reached to end a three-day strike that grounded hundreds of flights. **B1**
- ◆ **A tech selloff weighed** on the S&P 500 and Nasdaq, helping to depress them by 0.6% and 1.5%, respectively, while the Dow rose less than 0.1%. **B11**
- ◆ **S&P Global Ratings** affirmed the credit ratings of the U.S., citing revenue expected from Trump's tariffs. **A2**
- ◆ **Activist investor Ancora Holdings** told railroad operator CSX it should pursue a deal with a rival or replace its chief executive if it doesn't. **B1**
- ◆ **Medtronic added** two independent directors to its board and plans to establish committees on growth and operations after Elliott became one of its largest shareholders. **B3**
- ◆ **Databricks is** completing a funding round that would value the data-analytics software company at \$100 billion, a 61% increase from its last funding round. **B1**
- ◆ **NorthWestern Energy and Black Hills** agreed to combine to form a \$7.8 billion regulated electric and natural-gas utility company. **B3**
- ◆ **Peabody called off** a \$3.78 billion agreement to buy Anglo American's steel-making coal operations because of the shutdown of a mine central to the deal. **B3**
- ◆ **Xiaomi posted** record revenue from its Internet-of-Things business and robust EV sales and said its second-quarter net profit more than doubled. **B4**

World-Wide

- ◆ **Trump signaled** that the U.S. is prepared to use air power to support a European security force in Ukraine but ruled out deploying American ground troops. **A1, A6**
- ◆ **Elon Musk has grown** cautious about starting a new political party, telling allies he is reluctant to alienate powerful Republicans with a project that could siphon off Republican voters. **A1**
- ◆ **A Republican-led House** committee said it plans to publicly release some files it receives from the Justice Department related to convicted sex offender Jeffrey Epstein. **A4**
- ◆ **The Trump administration** intends to scrutinize social media for "anti-American ideologies" when deciding whether to grant visa or green-card applications. **A3**
- ◆ **Boston's mayor** addressed a public gathering to defend her city's sanctuary policy in the face of the White House's crackdown on illegal immigration. **A3**
- ◆ **A pediatrics group** recommended that parents inoculate their young children against Covid-19, diverging from federal health leaders who have questioned and shifted guidance for shots for kids. **A3**
- ◆ **Prosecutors charged** a 22-year-old Oregon man with operating a network of hacked devices blamed for knocking the X social-media site offline earlier this year. **A4**
- ◆ **Hamas accepted** a temporary cease-fire proposal instead of a complex offer intended to lead to an end to the war in Gaza, Arab mediators said. **A7**

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Surf's Up as Hurricane Erin Stirs Powerful Waves



JUST SWELL: Surfers silhouetted by the sunrise looked for the perfect wave Tuesday on Front Beach in Isle of Palms, S.C. The monster storm's center is expected to remain far offshore but the East Coast could get heavy winds and dangerous rip currents.

Musk Cools on New Party Idea, Weighs Backing Vance in 2028

By BRIAN SCHWARTZ

Billionaire Elon Musk is quietly pumping the brakes on his plans to start a new political party, according to people with knowledge of his plans. Musk has told allies that he wants to focus his attention on his companies and is reluctant to alienate powerful Republicans by starting a third party that could siphon off GOP voters.

Musk's posture marks a

shift from early last month, when he said he would form what he called the America Party to represent U.S. voters who are unhappy with the two major political parties. As he has considered whether to launch a new party, the Tesla CEO has been focused in part on maintaining ties with Vice President JD Vance, who is widely seen as a potential heir to the MAGA political movement. Musk has stayed in touch with Vance in

recent weeks and has acknowledged to associates that if he goes ahead with forming a new political party, he would damage his relationship with the vice president, the people said. Musk and his associates have told people close to him that he is considering using some of his vast financial resources to back Vance if he decides to run for president in 2028, some of the people said. Musk spent close to \$300 million to support

Trump and other Republicans in the 2024 election. The billionaire's allies said Musk hasn't formally ruled out creating a new party and could change his mind as the midterm elections near. But Musk and his team haven't engaged with many prominent individuals who have voiced support for the idea of a new party or could be a crucial resource to help it get off the ground, including

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President Weighs Air Aid To EU in Ukraine

Trump rules out putting U.S. troops on ground if a deal is reached to halt war

President Trump signaled on Tuesday that the U.S. is prepared to use air power to support a European security force in Ukraine but ruled out deploying American ground troops.

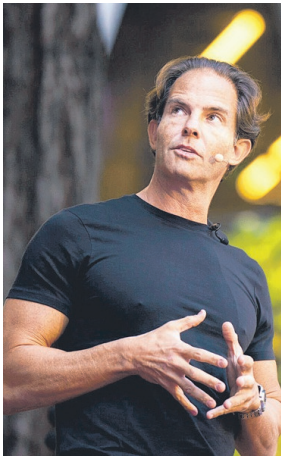
By Lara Seligman, Michael R. Gordon and Max Colchester

"When it comes to security, they are willing to put people on the ground," Trump said in a Fox News interview, referring to the Europeans. "We're willing to help them with things, especially probably, if you talk about by air, because there is nobody has the kind of stuff we have, really they don't have." Planning for the multinational force to be sent to Ukraine if a peace settlement is reached accelerated on Tuesday, a day after Trump discussed the idea at the White House with President Volodymyr Zelensky of Ukraine and other European leaders. After Trump's summit with his Russian counterpart in Alaska, the president tasked Air Force Gen. Dan Caine, the chairman of the Joint Chiefs of Staff, to develop options for NATO-like security guarantees for that force, a Western official said. Caine was set to meet in

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- ◆ **Forging a durable peace is Herculean task.....** A6
- ◆ **Putin's demands jeopardize hopes for Zelensky talks..** A6

INSIDE



BUSINESS & FINANCE
A luxury real-estate builder's improbable comeback starts to crumble. **B1**



PERSONAL JOURNAL
They needed a surrogate—so they asked a sibling to do it. **A9**

Tiny Trump Tower Firm Becomes First Family's Go-To Dealmaker

By DAVID UBERTI

To become a trusted financial partner of the world's most powerful family, it helps to buy low. That partly explains how a tiny onetime biotech firm with nearly a quarter-billion dollars in accumulated losses transformed into something of an in-house investment bank for the Trump family's business empire, handling everything from crypto to manufacturing deals. The ascent of the firm now known as Dominari Holdings began in 2021. Donald Trump's approval ratings had tanked after the Jan. 6 Capitol riot that

year. Democratic lawmakers and prosecutors were probing Trump and his company over what would become a slew of criminal and civil charges. Virtually no one on Wall Street was betting on Trump. Around the same time, Dominari Chief Executive Anthony Hayes was pondering a jump from the hit-or-miss work of drug development to the rough-and-tumble world of finance. He brought pal and Wall Street veteran Kyle Wool onto his board and they soon sought out bigger office space for their operation. They decided on a then-infamous piece of Manhattan real estate. "If we're going to

do something and we're going to build it from scratch, what about we grab a little space in Trump Tower?" Hayes said in a recent interview. The choice was made with a larger plan in mind. Trump's political comeback fueled an explosion of new business for his family, renewing criticisms that they are profiting off the U.S.'s highest office. The burst of activity created opportunities for a host of advisers like Dominari that for the most part weren't blue-chip names on Wall Street. Cantor Fitzgerald, now led in part by Commerce Secretary Howard Lutnick's sons, *Please turn to page A2*

Grab a Beer? Just Fill Out These Forms

* * *
In parts of India, getting a drink is a bureaucratic feat

By SHAN LI

GUJARAT INTERNATIONAL FINANCE TEC-CITY, India — Ashutosh Singh has enjoyed a dizzying surge in popularity over the past few months. What changed? The 36-year-old banker got a permit to enter the first bars in the western Indian state of Gujarat. Singh receives about 15 to 20 calls a week, often from strangers, begging to tag along for a drink—a novel experience in a state that has mostly prohibited alcohol for over six decades. "Sometimes I feel like Captain America," Singh said. "It's *Please turn to page A8*

A U.S. Journey Gave an Injured Boy a New Chance

Doctors in Gaza said he wouldn't live, but his mother wouldn't give up

By CHAO DENG

Boom. The explosion was still ringing in Ibrahim Abuowda's ears when he saw the schoolyard crowd scatter and looked up to see a limb flying above him. "I was wondering, whose arm is that?" the then-13-year-old recalled thinking, before fainting. A man he didn't know tried to carry him to safety but another explosion went off, sending shrapnel into Ibrahim's chest and injuring the man. The boy awoke when the man dropped him to the ground. Ibrahim's oldest brother then rushed to help.

They ducked behind tires and a third explosion went off, this time piercing Ibrahim's back with shrapnel. Their mother, Amani Abuowda, was in the school sheltering with her husband and their other children. She raced toward the schoolyard, toward the bombs, toward Ibrahim. Other women in the shelter blocked her path, and locked her in a classroom to keep her from going outside. When the explosions stopped, she said, she couldn't *Please turn to page A8*

- ◆ **Hamas accepts temporary cease-fire deal.....** A7

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